

WEIRD WORLD

EMPEROR CALIGULA HAD A HORSE CALLED INCITATUS. IT ATE FROM AN IVORY MANGER AND LIVED IN A MARBLE STABLE! CALIGULA EVEN THREATENED TO MAKE INCITATUS CONSUL!

or country governed by politicians elected by the people.

From republic to empire

The Roman Republic lasted for almost 500 years, from 509 BCE to 27 BCE. During this long time, Rome was ruled by the Senate—a group of

men who came from leading Roman families. The senators, as they were known, pledged that Rome would never again be in the hands of just one powerful person, such as a king.

Day-to-day decision-making was left in the hands of officials known as magistrates, who were elected for 1 year at a time. The two most important magistrates were the consuls. These men had the power to pass laws and declare war

THE SHADED AREAS ON THIS MAP SHOW THE GROWTH OF ROMAN TERRITORY.

